

CHINA DATA CENTERS

2Q26 Preview: Slower Move-In Pace Weighs on Quarter, But 12-Month Thesis Intact; Buy VNET/GDS/Range

Favorable developments in the China AI industry on both demand and supply sides have been supporting our constructive view on the China data center industry in the mid-to-long term. On the demand side, we believe **China's AI open-source/open-weight models** are reaching a critical point of intelligence performance for global proliferation, and continue to expand token share by pushing the **efficiency** frontiers of LLMs in terms of inference cost (e.g. DeepSeek, Xiaomi MiMo). We think these which should further drive data center demand (e.g. Zhipu has reportedly commissioned the construction of a 1GW data center).

Meanwhile, **domestic hardware systems** continue narrowing the gap with advanced imported chips, as illustrated by Huawei's Atlas 950 SuperPoD (scheduled for 2H26 shipment) and Alibaba's T-head Lingjun Zhenwu M890 SuperPoD (live and compatible with Qwen3.8). We estimate that Huawei's Atlas 950 SuperPoD may **double** the computational power and token throughput per GW vs. the prior Atlas 910C SuperPoD, and narrow the gap with Nvidia B300 to **1/4** from 1/8 in the case of Atlas 910C despite **3x** cost per computational power (Exhibit 5).

That said, **industry growth in 1H26 appears to be marginally slower than our prior expectations**, likely dragged by tighter chip availability (including domestic and imported chips). As per MIIT, China added **595EFLOPS** (FP16) intelligent computational power in 1H26 (Exhibit 3, equivalent to **0.7GW AI-related move-in** in 1H26 by GSe) to 2,185EFLOPS as of Jun 2026, below the 802EFLOPS addition in 2H25 and similar to 1H25 level when the Nvidia H20 export controls kicked in. We trim our 2026E China data center move-in demand estimate (AI and non-AI combined) to **c.3GW** (Exhibit 2) but continue to expect robust **20% demand CAGR in 2025-28E** from 16GW in 2025 to 27GW in 2028E (Exhibit 1).

Tighter chip availability coupled with robust AI training/inference demand has led to **surging spot rates in the GPUaaS/GPU rental business** as mentioned in our prior report (e.g. Nvidia H100 server monthly spot price almost doubled from c.Rmb50k in Jan-Feb to c.Rmb100k recently), while long-term contract price may not move as markedly, in our view. We note strong preliminary results from A-share companies involved in GPUaaS/GPU rental (all Not Covered) e.g. Sharetronic Data (300857.SZ), Lettall Electronic (603629.SS).

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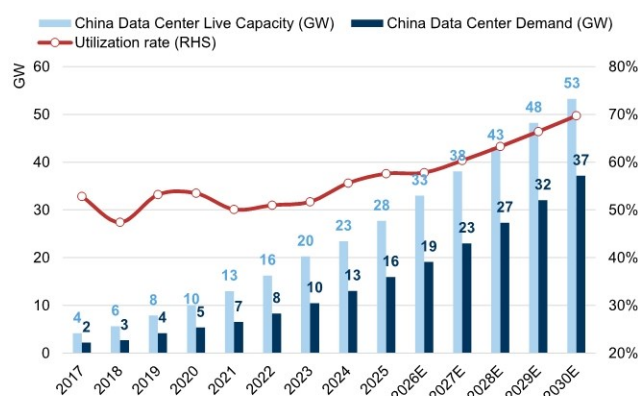
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Stock implications

- **GDS (Buy):** We keep 2Q26E forecasts unchanged and look for revenue +6% yoy to Rmb3.07bn (2% below Visible Alpha Consensus Data) and adj. EBITDA -2% yoy to Rmb1.34bn (2% above consensus). We lower 2027E revenue/adj. EBITDA by 2% but raise 2028E revenue/adj. EBITDA by 2% as we fine-tune our utilized capacity and MSR assumptions. Our 12-month TPs for GDS/9698.HK are lowered to US\$46/HK\$45 (from US\$49/HK\$47 prior), based on SOTP valuation in which we apply (all unchanged): 1) 13.5x target EV/EBITDA to GDS China's 2027E EBITDA; 2) 23x target EV/EBITDA to DayOne's 2027E EBITDA (unchanged), adjusted by the 19.9% stake owned by GDS; 3) 10% holdco. discount. We believe **the market has priced in the 500MW potential order volume in 1H26** given management's positive tone at the 1Q26 results call, and hence look for order updates in Jul-Aug.
- **VNET (Buy):** We lower 2Q26E revenue by 3% to Rmb2.77bn (+14% yoy being the trough level of the year, 1% below consensus) to account for slower move-in, but keep 2Q26E adj. EBITDA largely unchanged at Rmb927mn (+26% yoy, 2% above consensus). We fine-tune 2026-28E revenue and adj. EBITDA in the range of -1% to 0%. Our 12m TP is unchanged at US\$16 based on 12x 2027E EV/EBITDA. We also look for potentially more color on its **strategic collaboration with CATL** and **overseas expansion** at the results call, and see large new orders as a positive surprise.
- **A-share names:** We keep our estimates and TPs unchanged. **Range Intelligent (300442.SZ, Buy)** remains our preferred name among A-share data center operators, given its rich capacity reserves, full-stack AIDC capabilities (e.g. China's first 200MW, 100k chip-scale data center building operational starting from 1H26), strong customer relationships, and diverse, low-cost financing capabilities. We are Neutral rated on Athub (603881.SS) and Sell rated on Sinnet (300383.SZ).

Exhibit 1: We model c.3GW move-in demand in China data centers in 2026E, largely on par with 2025 despite stronger order volume

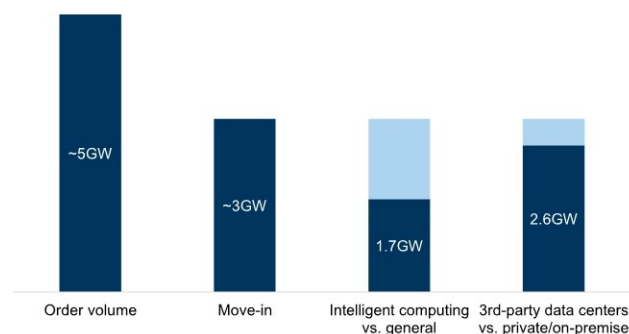
China data center live capacity vs. demand



Source: MIIT, CAICT, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: ... out of which we estimate 50%+ is attributable to intelligent computing demand and 80%+ is captured by third-party data centers

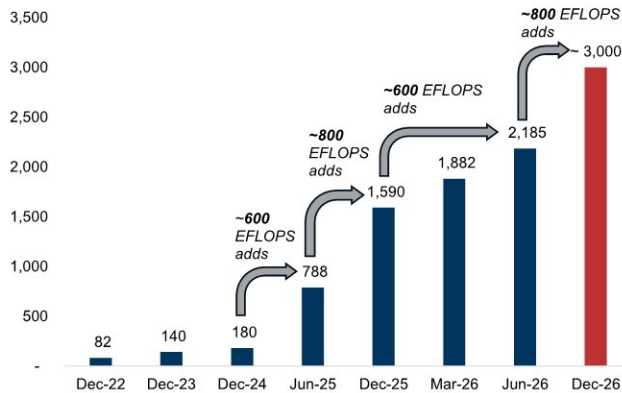
2026E China data center order volume and move-in breakdown



Source: MIIT, NEA, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

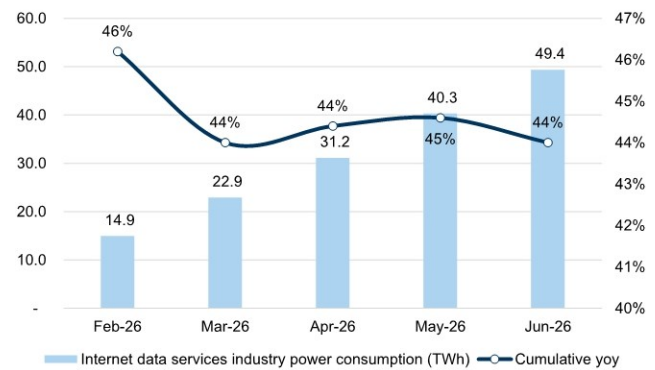
Exhibit 3: China's ~600 EFLOPS intelligent computational power addition in 1H26 tracks below 2H25 run rate, yet we expect the pace to re-accelerate in 2H26E

China's intelligent computational power (EFLOPS, FP16)



Source: MIIT, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: China's internet data services industry power consumption growth stayed robust at 44% yoy in 1H26



Source: NEA

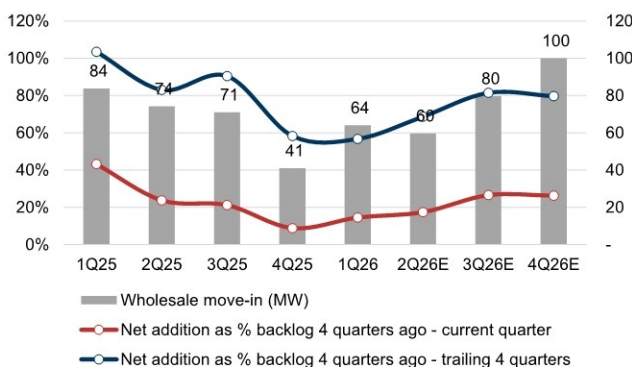
Exhibit 5: Economics of a 200MW IT power data center based on different IT infrastructure

Capex per 200MW IT power data center	Nvidia B300	Nvidia H800	Huawei CM384 910C	Huawei CM1024 950	vs. 910C	vs. B300
Computing power (EFLOPS, FP16)	250	240	80	76		
Computing power (EFLOPS, FP8)	500	480	80	142		
Total IT power (kW)	187,500	190,400	208,800	199,066		
Servers/supernodes #	12,500	20,000	261	135		
GPUs # per unit	8	8	384	1,024		
CPUs # per unit	2	2	192	256		
Computing power per unit (PFLOPS, FP16)	20	12	307	563		
Computing power per GPU (TFLOPS, FP16)	2,500	1,500	800	550		
Computing power per GPU (TFLOPS, FP8)	5,000	3,000	800	1,024		
IT power per unit (kW)	15	10	800	1,475		
TDP per GPU (W)	1,400	700	800	600		
Coefficient	1.3	1.7	2.6	2.4		
IT power per server (kW)	15	10	17	12		
Total capex (Rmb bn)	61.0	54.8	41.0	54.9		
Capex per IT power (Rmb bn/GW)	325	288	196	276	1.4x	0.8x
Capex per computing power (Rmb bn/EFLOPS, FP8)	0.12	0.11	0.51	0.39	0.8x	3.2x
Computing power per IT power (EFLOPS/GW, FP8)	2,667	2,521	384	711	1.9x	0.3x

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: We expect VNET's move-in pace related to order backlog to improve qoq in 2Q26E yet absolute move-in (MW) may drop qoq

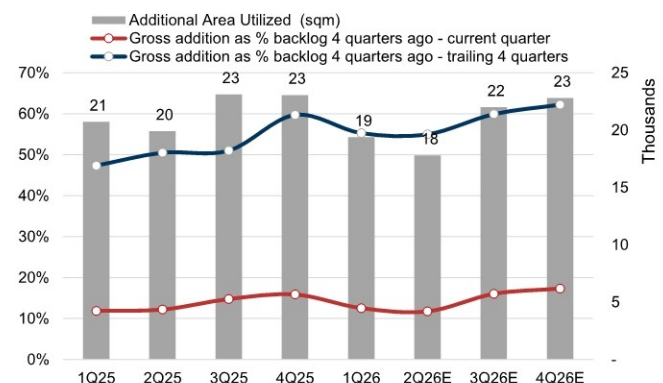
VNET's net addition as % backlog 4 quarters ago



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: ...while GDS' move-in pace moderated in 1Q26 and we expect it to be marginally softer in 2Q26E

GDS' gross addition as % backlog 4 quarters ago



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

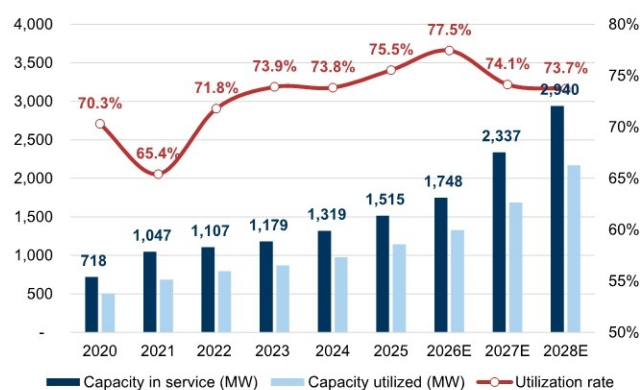
GDS Holdings (GDS/9698.HK)

9698.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$45	Price: HK\$31.42	Upside: 43.2%
GDS	12m Price Target: \$46	Price: \$31.63	Upside: 45.4%

Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: \$6.1bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Enterprise value: \$11.6bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	11,432.3	12,712.7	13,600.3	16,103.2
3m ADTV: \$83.4mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	5,403.5	5,973.4	6,098.2	7,159.9
China	EPS (Rmb) New	4.71	11.47	(1.37)	1.25
China Internet Verticals	EPS (Rmb) Old	4.71	11.53	(0.83)	0.64
M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)	48.0	18.7	NM	170.8
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	P/B (X)	1.7	1.6	1.3	1.2
	Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	8.0	12.1	7.6	7.8
	EPS (Rmb)	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		13.51	(0.51)	(0.74)	(0.78)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 24 Jul 2025 close.

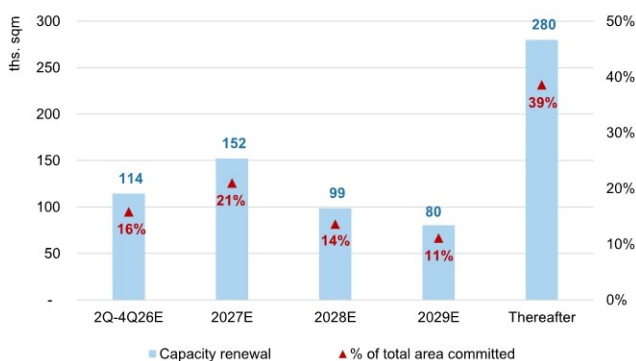
Exhibit 8: We forecast 25%/24% CAGR in 2025-28E for both capacity in service and capacity utilized to 2.9GW/2.2GW in-service/utilized capacity by 2028E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: GDS expects to renew 16%/21% of committed area in 2Q-4Q26E/27E, one of key drivers behind MSR decline

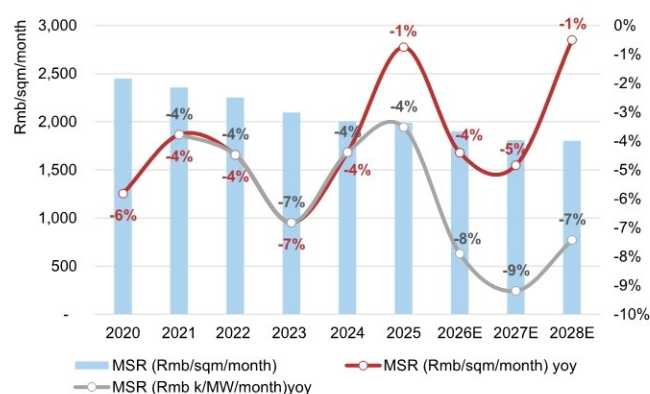
Contract renewal area sqm and % of total area committed



Source: Company data

Exhibit 9: We continue to expect MSR to decline 7-9% yoy in 2026-28E in Rmb/kW terms

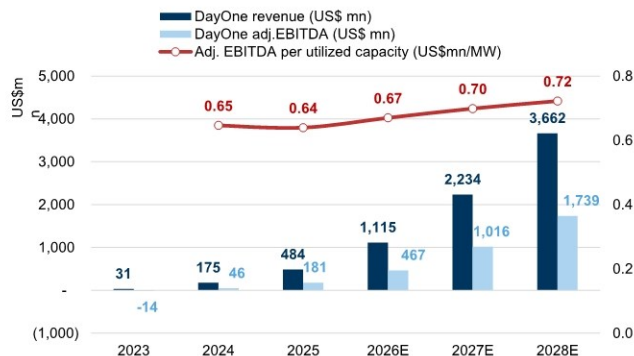
GDS China annual MSR



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: We expect revenue/adj.EBITDA of DayOne to grow at 96%/113% 2025-28E CAGRs

DayOne annual revenue, adj.EBITDA and adj.EBITDA margin



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: Our SOTP-based target prices for GDS/9698.HK are US\$46 and HK\$45

	EV/ EBITDA	27E EBITDA	Enterprise value	Net debt	Equity value	Value to GDS	% val	Val/ ADS	Val/ share
		Rmb mn	Rmb mn	Rmb mn	Rmb mn	Rmb mn		US\$	HK\$
GDS China	13.5x	6,098	82,326	28,030	54,297	54,297	76%	34.9	34.0
DayOne	23.0x	7,268	167,153	39,022	128,130	25,498	36%	16.4	16.0
Total	18.7x	13,366	249,479	67,052	182,427	79,794	111%	51.4	50.0
Holdco discount	10%					(7,979)	-11%	(5.1)	(5.0)
12m target price	16.4x		99,845	28,030		71,815	100%	46.0	45.0

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: GDS & DayOne financials summary

GDS China (Rmb mn)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
Net revenue	10,322	11,432	12,713	13,600	16,103	2,723	2,900	2,887	2,922	3,367	3,073	3,106	3,166
COGS	(4,893)	(5,517)	(6,158)	(6,826)	(8,082)	(1,268)	(1,391)	(1,415)	(1,444)	(1,415)	(1,545)	(1,591)	(1,606)
Utility cost	(3,361)	(3,995)	(4,533)	(5,053)	(5,983)	(893)	(1,012)	(1,030)	(1,060)	(1,037)	(1,134)	(1,171)	(1,191)
Rent, Labour & Other cost	(1,532)	(1,522)	(1,625)	(1,772)	(2,099)	(375)	(379)	(384)	(384)	(378)	(411)	(420)	(416)
Adjusted gross profit	5,429	5,915	6,555	6,775	8,021	1,455	1,510	1,473	1,478	1,952	1,528	1,516	1,560
Sales and marketing expenses	(116)	(149)	(173)	(185)	(211)	(33)	(34)	(40)	(42)	(37)	(41)	(46)	(49)
General and admin expenses	(918)	(896)	(944)	(1,010)	(1,179)	(239)	(232)	(228)	(199)	(177)	(256)	(257)	(253)
Research and development expenses	(36)	(33)	(40)	(42)	(50)	(8)	(9)	(8)	(8)	(10)	(10)	(10)	(10)
Total operating expenses	(1,071)	(1,080)	(1,156)	(1,237)	(1,440)	(280)	(274)	(277)	(249)	(224)	(307)	(313)	(312)
Adjusted EBITDA	4,876	5,403	5,973	6,098	7,160	1,324	1,372	1,342	1,366	1,949	1,339	1,319	1,366
Operating profit (non-GAAP)	1,633	1,944	2,378	1,950	2,551	467	515	481	480	1,117	454	402	405
Net income	(771)	895	2,229	(267)	244	750	(86)	712	(481)	2,624	(99)	(144)	(152)
Net income (non-GAAP)	(289)	2,243	616	173	683	894	56	1,309	(15)	725	(6)	(50)	(52)
Adjusted GPM %	52.6%	51.7%	51.6%	49.8%	49.8%	53.4%	52.0%	51.0%	50.6%	58.0%	49.7%	48.8%	49.3%
Adjusted EBITDA %	47.2%	47.3%	47.0%	44.8%	44.5%	48.6%	47.3%	46.5%	46.7%	57.9%	43.6%	42.5%	43.2%
Operating profit, adj.	15.8%	17.0%	18.7%	14.3%	15.8%	17.2%	17.8%	16.7%	16.4%	33.2%	14.8%	12.9%	12.8%
Net income %	-7.5%	7.8%	17.5%	-2.0%	1.5%	27.5%	-3.0%	24.7%	-16.4%	77.9%	-3.2%	-4.6%	-4.8%
Net income (non-GAAP) %	-2.8%	19.6%	4.8%	1.3%	4.2%	32.8%	1.9%	45.3%	-0.5%	21.5%	-0.2%	-1.6%	-1.6%
Operating metrics													
Area in service (sqm)	613,583	668,283	738,283	918,283	1,098,283	610,685	618,060	653,762	668,283	674,269	689,269	711,269	738,304
yoy%	12%	9%	10%	24%	20%	11%	7%	10%	9%	10%	12%	9%	10%
Area utilized (sqm)	453,094	504,843	571,864	680,864	809,864	462,423	479,186	486,607	504,843	520,929	534,929	553,129	571,864
yoy%	12%	11%	13%	19%	19%	15%	14%	11%	11%	13%	12%	14%	13%
MSR (Rmb/sqm/month)	2,004	1,989	1,901	1,809	1,800	1,983	2,053	1,993	1,965	1,909	1,940	1,903	1,876
yoy%	-4%	-1%	-4%	-5%	-1%	-1%	-2%	-2%	-2%	-4%	-6%	-5%	-5%
Utilization rate	73.8%	75.5%	77.5%	74.1%	73.7%	75.7%	77.5%	74.4%	75.5%	77.3%	77.6%	77.8%	77.5%
DayOne (US\$ mn)													
Revenue	174	484	1,115	2,234	3,662	66	86	138	195	221	240	291	364
yoy%	454%	178%	130%	100%	64%	131%	144%	177%	221%	234%	181%	110%	87%
Adj EBITDA	46	181	467	1,016	1,739	19	30	60	73	90	101	131	146
yoy%	NM	295%	158%	118%	71%	191%	165%	358%	383%	375%	239%	119%	101%
Adj EBITDA margin	26%	37%	42%	46%	48%	29%	35%	43%	37%	41%	42%	45%	40%
Total IT Power Utilized (MW)	121	444	949	1,958	2,856	143	213	369	444	474	578	739	949
Total IT Power Committed (MW)	467	1,250	2,250	3,050	3,850	537	783	837	1,250	1,526	1,776	2,026	2,250

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis - GDS Holdings

GDS is the leader in China's carrier-neutral data center market with a wholesale-centric business model. We see GDS has established a clear leadership as the largest data center platform in China in terms of developable capacity via resource expansion in key computing clusters, and fortified its balance sheet via financial discipline and capital recycling, and hence is poised to capture demand from key customers including China's top hyperscalers. For DayOne, as it becomes a standalone business with a different growth/profitability profile, we see strong contract move-in visibility in the near-term and continued capacity expansion in the mid-term.

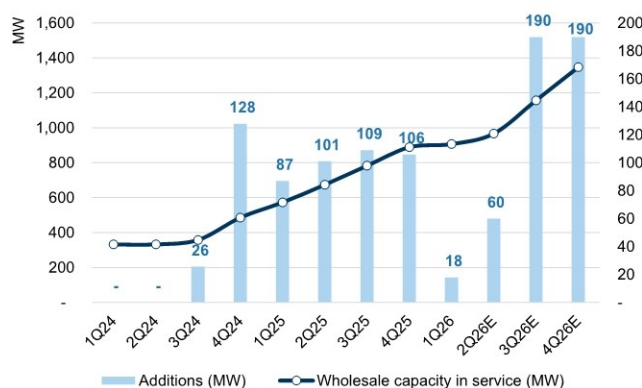
Price Target Risks and Methodology - GDS Holdings

Our 12m target prices of **US\$46/HK\$45** for GDS/9698.HK are based on a SOTP valuation for GDS China and DayOne, with a 10% holdco discount. Key downside risks: Below-expected move-in demand and utilization improvement, slower overseas revenue/profitability ramp-up, lower-than-expected pricing trend in China and overseas markets, customer churn, slower deleveraging process.

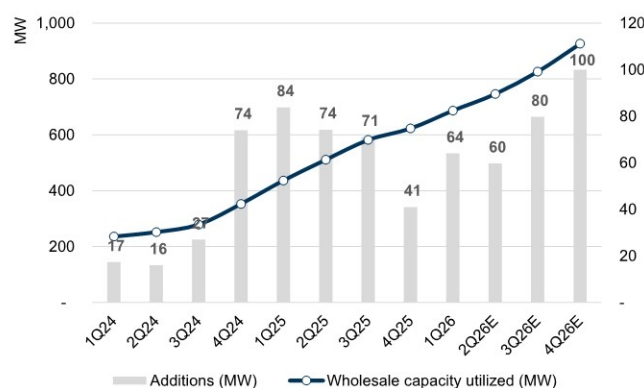
VNET Group (VNET)

VNET	12m Price Target: \$16	Price: \$7.21	Upside: 121.9%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: \$2.0bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Enterprise value: \$5.5bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	9,949.3	11,523.1	13,537.0	15,579.5
	3m ADTV: \$67.7mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	9,949.3	11,653.9	13,704.5	15,730.8
	China	EPS (Rmb) New	2,978.2	3,707.2	4,574.6	5,488.2
	China Internet Verticals	EPS (Rmb) Old	(0.98)	(8.76)	(0.72)	(0.20)
		P/E (X)	(0.98)	(8.78)	(0.76)	(0.23)
	M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
	Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Dividend yield (%)	2.0	1.5	1.9	2.9
		CROCI (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
			8.2	5.8	8.5	8.3
			3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	(8.13)	(0.18)	(0.31)	(0.39)	

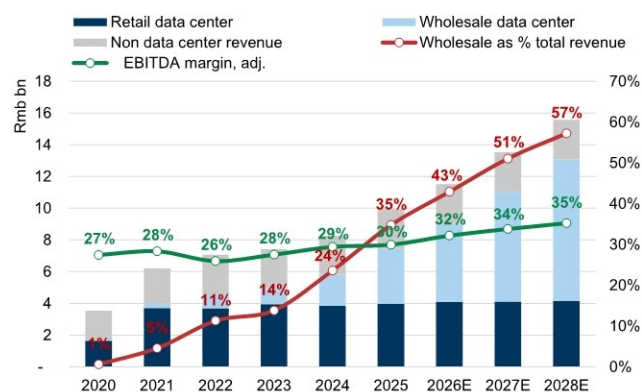
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 24 Jul 2026 close.

Exhibit 14: We model backloaded additions of capacity in service in 2026E

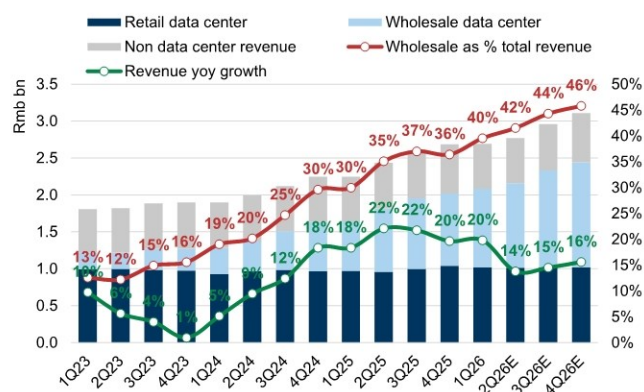
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15:as well as backloaded additions of capacity utilized

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: We expect wholesale IDC to account for 57% of VNET's revenue by 2028E vs. 35% in 2025
VNET revenue breakdown (Rmb bn)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 17: On a quarterly basis, we model 2Q26E revenue growth to moderate to +14% yoy from +20% in 1Q26
VNET quarterly revenue breakdown

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: Our 12m target price for VNET is unchanged at US\$16.0

Rmb mn	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E
Revenue	7,065	7,413	8,259	9,949	11,523	13,537
yoy	14%	5%	11%	20%	16%	17%
EBITDA, adj.	1,832	2,039	2,430	2,978	3,707	4,575
yoy	4%	11%	19%	23%	24%	23%
EBITDA margin	25.9%	27.5%	29.4%	29.9%	32.2%	33.8%
Target EV/EBITDA	30.0x	26.9x	22.6x	18.4x	14.8x	12.0x
Enterprise value 12m-fwd						54,896
Net debt	7,658	6,390	9,636	13,391	22,027	27,723
Net debt/EBITDA	4.2x	3.1x	4.0x	4.5x	5.9x	6.1x
Equity value 12m-fwd (Rmb mn)				32,868		
ADSs outstanding (mn)				283		
Dilutive impact from 2027 Convertible Notes				25		
Target price (US\$)				16.0		

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: VNET summary financials

Rmb mn	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	1Q26	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
Net revenue	8,259	9,949	11,523	13,537	15,580	2,691	2,770	2,956	3,106
Wholesale data centers	1,951	3,461	4,946	6,914	8,917	1,064	1,150	1,309	1,422
Retail data centers	3,838	3,966	4,072	4,118	4,158	1,021	1,011	1,020	1,021
Cloud and VPN	2,469	2,523	2,505	2,505	2,505	606	609	627	663
yoy%	11%	20%	16%	17%	15%	20%	14%	15%	16%
Wholesale data centers	90%	77%	43%	40%	29%	58%	35%	37%	45%
Retail data centers	-3%	3%	3%	1%	1%	5%	5%	2%	-2%
Cloud and VPN	1%	2%	-1%	0%	0%	0%	-2%	0%	-1%
Mix %									
Wholesale data centers	24%	35%	43%	51%	57%	40%	42%	44%	46%
Retail data centers	46%	40%	35%	30%	27%	38%	37%	34%	33%
Cloud and VPN	30%	25%	22%	19%	16%	23%	22%	21%	21%
COGS	(4,922)	(5,731)	(6,544)	(7,613)	(8,684)	(1,480)	(1,545)	(1,731)	(1,788)
Adjusted gross profit	3,337	4,218	4,980	5,924	6,896	1,211	1,225	1,225	1,318
Sales and marketing expenses	(264)	(279)	(255)	(282)	(298)	(54)	(64)	(65)	(72)
General and administrative	(659)	(797)	(820)	(877)	(918)	(162)	(205)	(204)	(248)
R&D expenses	(247)	(261)	(319)	(359)	(381)	(74)	(77)	(82)	(86)
Total operating expenses	(1,163)	(1,412)	(1,487)	(1,611)	(1,690)	(369)	(351)	(356)	(411)
EBITDA, adj.	2,430	2,978	3,707	4,575	5,488	892	927	925	965
yoy%	19%	23%	24%	23%	20%	31%	26%	22%	20%
Operating profit	669	780	866	1,255	1,757	247	227	195	197
Operating profit, non-GAAP	818	806	895	1,288	1,795	254	234	202	205
GPM%	40.4%	42.4%	43.2%	43.8%	44.3%	45.0%	44.2%	41.4%	42.4%
Sales and marketing expenses	3.2%	2.8%	2.2%	2.1%	1.9%	2.0%	2.3%	2.2%	2.3%
General and administrative	8.0%	8.0%	7.1%	6.5%	5.9%	6.0%	7.4%	6.9%	8.0%
R&D expenses	3.0%	2.6%	2.8%	2.7%	2.4%	2.8%	2.8%	2.8%	2.8%
OPEX	14.1%	14.2%	12.9%	11.9%	10.8%	13.7%	12.7%	12.0%	13.2%
EBITDA margin, adj.	29.4%	29.9%	32.2%	33.8%	35.2%	33.1%	33.5%	31.3%	31.1%
OPM non-GAAP	9.9%	8.1%	7.8%	9.5%	11.5%	9.4%	8.5%	6.8%	6.6%
Operating metrics									
Capacity in service (MW)	715	1,108	1,568	1,918	2,218	1,128	1,187	1,378	1,568
Capacity utilized (MW)	498	763	1,068	1,451	1,752	828	888	968	1,068
Overall utilization rate	70%	69%	68%	76%	79%	73%	75%	70%	68%
Wholesale data centers									
Wholesale capacity in service (MW)	486	889	1,347	1,697	1,997	907	967	1,157	1,347
Wholesale capacity utilized (MW)	353	623	926	1,309	1,609	687	747	826	926
yoy%	61%	76%	49%	41%	23%	57%	46%	42%	49%
Utilization rate	73%	70%	69%	77%	81%	76%	77%	71%	69%
Monthly service revenue (Rmb/MW/m)	568,830	591,001	532,038	515,545	509,358	541,643	534,602	554,917	541,044
yoy%	-2%	4%	-10%	-3%	-1%	-5%	-11%	-5%	0%
Retail data centers									
Available cabinets	52,107	49,863	50,170	50,247	50,324	50,170	50,020	50,170	50,170
Billable cabinets	33,068	31,906	32,190	32,390	32,540	32,159	32,094	32,190	32,190
Utilization rate	63%	64%	64%	64%	65%	64%	64%	64%	64%
MRR	8,790	9,365	9,469	9,517	9,564	9,448	9,450	9,503	9,514
yoy%	-1%	7%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis - VNET Group

VNET, China's leading carrier-neutral data center operator, derived c.75% of its 2025 revenue from IDCs vs. c.25% from cloud computing and VAS. We see VNET transforming itself from a traditional retail IDC operator to a fast-growing wholesale IDC operator and entering a revenue/EBITDA growth acceleration phase over the next few years from intensifying AI investment, with wholesale IDC growing at 37-38% revenue/EBITDA CAGRs in 2025-28E. We believe rising wholesale IDC revenue/EBITDA contributions should lead to continued upward multiple re-rating and valuation compounding for VNET. We are Buy rated.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - VNET Group

We have a 12m target price of US\$16, based on a target 12m-fwd EV/EBITDA multiple

of 12x applied to 2027E adj. EBITDA. Key risks: 1) inability to finance the growth objectives; 2) softer-than-expected execution on order wins; 3) geopolitical risks regarding AI; 4) further downturn of traditional businesses; 5) faster than or unexpected change in AI model training demand brought by the latest development in technology.

Investment Thesis - Range Intelligent

Range Intelligent is one of China's largest data center operators in terms of live capacity (750MW as of 2025) and reserved capacity (6GW as of late, the majority of which has secured power quota approvals). We are Buy-rated as we see Range Intelligent as one of the fastest growing data center operators in China, with 27%/33% utilized IT capacity/revenue CAGRs for 2025-30E. This growth is supported by its: 1) rich capacity reserves to capture rising computing cluster demand, 2) full-stack AIDC capabilities to enable long-term operational stability and technology investments, 3) strong customer relationships with reduced customer concentration, and 4) diverse, low-cost financing capabilities. We expect the company's GPU-as-a-Service (GPUaaS) investments to generate incremental profitability in a favorable demand and pricing environment. Furthermore, we are positive about its overseas expansion initiatives to capture rising AI demand in the APAC region in the long term, which leverage Range's supply chain and human resource capabilities.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Range Intelligent

Valuation: Our 12-month target price of Rmb117 is based on an 18x 2030E EV/EBITDA discounted back to end-2026E at a 10% CoE. The 18x target EV/EBITDA multiple is a weighted average of: i) a 25x target EV/EBITDA multiple to the DC operation EBITDA and ii) a 10x target EV/EBITDA multiple to GPUaaS.

Key risks: 1) Lower-than-expected order wins amid a competitive environment; 2) Slower-than-expected utilization rate ramp-up; 3) Larger-than-expected pricing pressure; 4) Worse-than-expected execution in overseas expansion; 5) Changes in chip availability due to regulatory changes, domestic capacity ramp-up delays, etc; 6) Difficulties in financing.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

I, Timothy Zhao, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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Disclosures

Rating and pricing information

Beijing Sinnet Technology Co Ltd. (Sell, Rmb12.31), Range Intelligent (Buy, Rmb64.80) and Shanghai Athub (Neutral, Rmb24.22)

The rating(s) for GDS Holdings (ADR), GDS Holdings (H) and VNET Group is/are relative to the other companies in its/their coverage universe:

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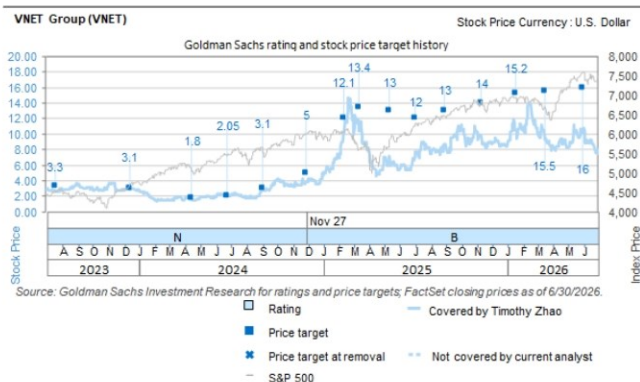
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

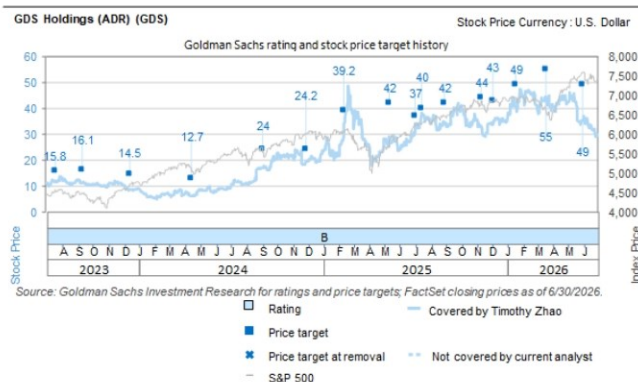
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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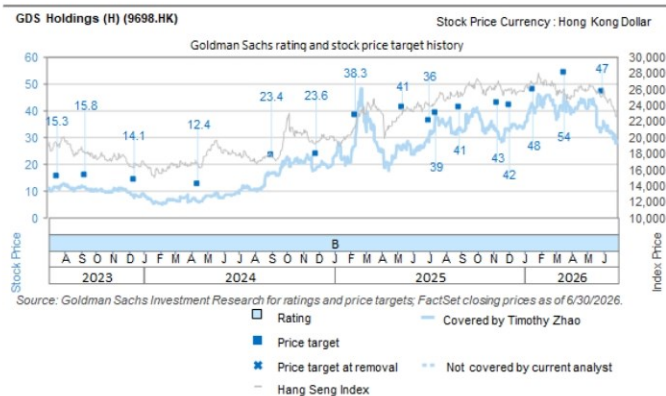
Price target and rating history chart(s)



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Target price history table(s)

GDS Holdings (H) (9698.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
30-May-26	47.00	33.28
18-Mar-26	54.00	45.98
18-Jan-26	48.00	41.86
03-Dec-25	42.00	32.50
11-Nov-25	43.00	32.60
29-Aug-25	41.00	33.76
15-Jul-25	39.00	38.65
04-Jul-25	36.00	32.25
12-May-25	41.00	27.20
11-Feb-25	38.30	30.00
27-Nov-24	23.60	18.28

VNET Group (VNET)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-May-26	16.00	10.08
16-Mar-26	15.50	9.53
18-Jan-26	15.20	10.56
11-Nov-25	14.00	9.79
29-Aug-25	13.00	8.66
04-Jul-25	12.00	7.75
12-May-25	13.00	7.23
12-Mar-25	13.40	11.00
11-Feb-25	12.10	9.97
27-Nov-24	5.00	3.86
03-Sep-24	3.10	2.71

GDS Holdings (H) (9698.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
03-Sep-24	23.40	16.70
15-Apr-24	12.40	6.17
14-Dec-23	14.10	8.34
11-Sep-23	15.80	11.24

VNET Group (VNET)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
25-Jun-24	2.05	2.24
15-Apr-24	1.80	1.58
14-Dec-23	3.10	2.94

GDS Holdings (ADR) (GDS)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-May-26	49.00	35.45
18-Mar-26	55.00	44.49
18-Jan-26	49.00	40.66
03-Dec-25	43.00	33.74
11-Nov-25	44.00	33.33
29-Aug-25	42.00	34.56
15-Jul-25	40.00	37.72
04-Jul-25	37.00	33.98
12-May-25	42.00	29.13
11-Feb-25	39.20	34.29
27-Nov-24	24.20	19.54
03-Sep-24	24.00	16.98
15-Apr-24	12.70	6.12
14-Dec-23	14.50	8.78
11-Sep-23	16.10	11.37

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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